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DIGITAL MARKETING (DE103305)

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Chapter -3 Website Analytics

1. Data collection

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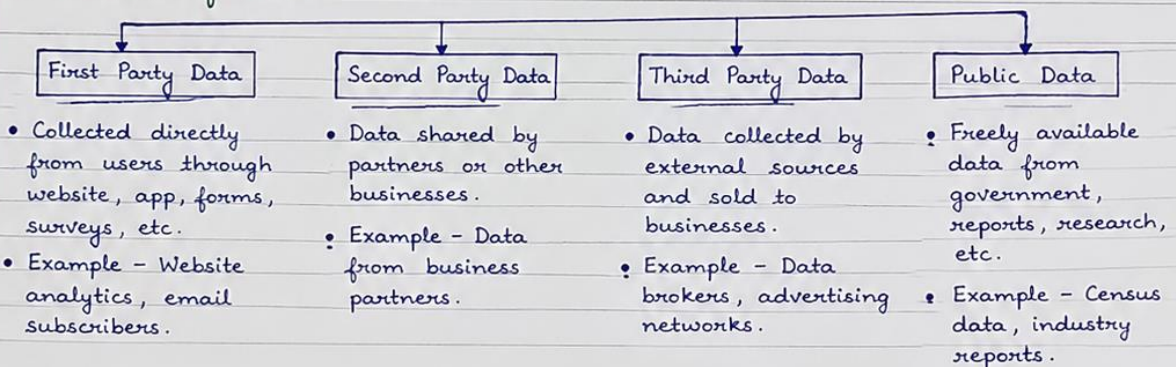
Data collection

Data collection is the process of gathering information about users, their behavior, preferences and interactions across digital channels. It helps marketers to understand the audience, measure performance and take data-driven decisions.

1. Importance of Data Collection

- Helps in understanding customer behavior and needs.
- Enables effective segmentation and targeting.
- Improves marketing campaign performance.
- Helps in personalization and customer satisfaction.
- Supports decision making and strategy development.

2. Sources of Data



3. Methods of Data Collection

- Web Analytics Tools - Google Analytics, Adobe Analytics.
- Forms & Surveys - Google Forms, Typeform, SurveyMonkey.
- Cookies & Tracking Pixels - Track user behavior and conversions.
- Social Media Insights - Data from likes, shares, comments, followers.
- CRM & Databases - Customer information, purchase history, interactions.
- Email Tracking - Open rates, click-through rates.

4. Best Practices

- Collect only relevant data.
- Ensure data accuracy and reliability.
- Respect user privacy and follow data protection laws (GDPR, etc.).
- Use data ethically and transparently.
- Regularly update and clean data.

5. Challenges

- Data privacy and security concerns.
- Inaccurate or incomplete data.
- Data overload.
- Integration of data from multiple sources.
- Keeping up with changing regulations.

2. Weblogs & Page tagging

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Weblogs & Page tagging

1. Weblogs (Blogs)

A weblog or blog is an online journal or informational website that displays content in reverse chronological order. It is regularly updated and written in an informal or conversational style. Blogs are widely used in digital marketing to build brand awareness, share information, engage customers and improve search engine visibility.

Benefits of Weblogs

- Builds brand authority and credibility.
- Improves SEO through fresh content.
- Drives website traffic.
- Engages customers through comments and sharing.
- Helps in lead generation.

Example

A digital marketing blog may publish articles on SEO tips, social media updates, case studies, and industry trends to attract and educate readers.

2. Page Tagging

Page tagging is the process of adding small pieces of code (tags) to web pages or digital assets to track user interactions and collect data. These tags help in measuring performance, analyzing user behavior, and optimizing marketing campaigns.

Common Types of Page Tags

- Analytics Tags - Track website visits, page views, and user behavior.
- Conversion Tags - Track specific actions like purchases, sign-ups, downloads.
- Remarketing Tags - Show ads to users who have visited the website.
- Heatmap Tags - Analyze how users interact with pages (clicks, scrolls).

Example

Google Analytics tag is added to a website page to track visitors, page views, bounce rate, and other important metrics.

3. Importance of Weblogs & Page Tagging in Digital Marketing

- Helps in data-driven decision making.
- Improves website performance and user experience.
- Supports targeted marketing and personalization.
- Increases ROI of digital marketing campaigns.

Tip

Always ensure proper tag placement and respect user privacy while collecting data.

3. Key metrics: Unique visitors

- A. Pageviews
- B. Pages/visit
- C. Avg Visit Duration
- D. Bounce rate
- E. New Visits

Key metrics of Web Analytics

Key metrics help digital marketers understand how users interact with a website or application. These metrics provide valuable insights into performance, user behavior, content effectiveness and campaign success. The most important web analytics metrics are explained below:

1. Unique Visitors

Unique visitors refers to the number of distinct individuals who visit your website within a specific time period. If the same person visits multiple times, he/she is counted only once.

Why it is important:

- It indicates the actual reach of your website.
- Helps in measuring brand awareness and audience growth.
- Used to evaluate the effectiveness of marketing campaigns.

How it is calculated:

Unique Visitors = Number of distinct users in a given time period

Example

If 150 people visit your site in a day, and 40 of them return multiple times, the Unique Visitors will be 110.

Tips to improve:

- Create valuable and shareable content.
- Use SEO and social media to drive traffic.
- Run targeted ad campaigns.

2. Pageviews

Pageviews is the total number of pages viewed on your website during a specific time. It includes repeated views of the same page.

Why it is important:

- Shows the overall popularity of your content.
- Helps in measuring user interest and engagement.
- Useful for evaluating content strategies.

How it is calculated:

Pageviews = Total number of pages viewed (including repeats)

Example

If a visitor views 5 pages and another visitor views 3 pages in a single visit, the total pageviews will be 8.

Tips to improve:

- Publish high-quality and relevant content.
- Use internal linking to encourage more page views.
- Optimize content for better user experience.

★ High pageviews with low engagement may indicate that users are not finding what they need. Always analyze with other metrics. ★

3. Pages / Visit (or Page Depth)

Pages per visit is the average number of pages a user views in a single visit to your website.

Why it is important:

- Indicates how engaging your content is.
- Higher value means users are exploring more.
- Helps in measuring website navigation and structure.

How it is calculated:

Pages / Visit = $\frac{\text{Total Pageviews}}{\text{Total Visits}}$

Example

If your website has 600 pageviews and 200 visits,
Pages / Visit = $600 / 200 = 3$
(Average 3 pages viewed per visit)

Tips to improve:

- Organize content in a logical structure.
- Add relevant internal links.
- Use clear navigation and attractive CTAs.

4. Avg. Visit Duration

Average visit duration is the average length of time users spend on your website per visit.

Why it is important:

- Longer duration indicates higher engagement.
- Shows that users find your content useful.
- Helps in evaluating content quality.

How it is calculated:

Avg. Visit Duration = $\frac{\text{Total time spent by all visitors}}{\text{Total Visits}}$

Example

If total time spent on your site in a day is 2,400 minutes and total visits are 300,
Avg. Visit Duration = $2400 / 300 = 8$ minutes

Tips to improve:

- Create valuable, in-depth and engaging content.
- Use visuals, videos and infographics.
- Improve website speed and mobile experience.

5. Bounce Rate

Bounce rate is the percentage of visitors who land on a page and leave without visiting any other page.

Why it is important:

- High bounce rate may indicate content not relevant to user intent.
- A low bounce rate means users are exploring more.
- Important for landing pages and blog posts.

How it is calculated:

Bounce Rate (%) = $(\text{Single Page Visits} / \text{Total Visits}) \times 100$

Example

If 120 visitors left after viewing only one page and total visits are 500,
Bounce Rate = $(120 / 500) \times 100 = 24\%$

Tips to reduce bounce rate:

- Provide relevant and engaging content.
- Improve page loading speed.
- Use clear headlines, visuals and internal links.
- Match content with user intent.

Note: A good bounce rate varies by industry. Generally, below 40% is considered good.

Industry Benchmarks (Approx.)

Blog / Content Sites	: 60 - 80%
E-commerce Sites	: 20 - 45%
Landing Pages	: 70 - 90%
Service Websites	: 40 - 60%

4. Types of web analytics Tools:

- A. Content analytics tools
- B. Customer analytics tools, Usability (UX) analytics tools
- C. A/B and multivariate testing tools
- D. Social media analytics tools
- E. SEO analytics tools
- F. General enterprise analytics tools
- G. Open source web analytics tools
- H. Product analytics tools

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4. Types of Web Analytics Tools

A. Content analytics tools

These tools focus on analyzing the performance of website content such as pages, blogs, videos, infographics, whitepapers, etc. They help marketers understand what content works best, how users interact with it and which topics drive the most engagement.

What they do:

- Track page views, time on page, scroll depth
- Identify popular content and topics
- Measure content engagement and shares
- Analyse content optimization opportunities
- Help in content strategy and planning

Examples:

- Google Analytics (Behavior Flow, Content Reports)
- Chartbeat
- Parse.ly
- ContentSquare
- Hotjar (Content Overview)
- Adobe Analytics (Content Analysis)

B. Customer analytics tools, Usability (UX) analytics tools

These tools help in understanding user behavior, preferences and journey on the website or app. They focus on user experience interaction patterns and usability issues that affect conversions.

What they do:

- Track user journeys and behavior flow
- Identify drop-off points and friction areas
- Session recordings & heatmaps
- Analyze user feedback and surveys
- Improve website design and user experience
- Customer segmentation and profiling

Examples:

- Hotjar (Heatmaps, Session Recordings)
- Crazy Egg
- Microsoft Clarity
- FullStory
- UserTesting
- Lucky Orange
- Mixpanel (User Behavior)

C. A/B and multivariate testing tools

These tools allow marketers to test different variations of web pages, headlines, CTAs, images, colors, or layouts to find which version performs better. They help in improving conversions and ROI.

What they do:

- A/B testing (two versions)
- Multivariate testing (multiple variations)
- Test headlines, CTAs, images, forms, etc.
- Improve conversions and ROI
- Data-driven decision making

Examples:

- Google Optimize
- Optimizely
- VWO (Visual Website Optimizer)
- Adobe Target
- Convert
- AB Tasty

4. Types of Web Analytics Tools

D. Social media analytics tools

These tools track and analyze social media performance across platforms. They help measure engagement, reach, audience growth and campaign effectiveness.

What they do:

- Track likes, shares, comments, mentions
- Monitor brand conversations and hashtags
- Analyze audience demographics & interests
- Measure post and campaign performance
- Competitor analysis

Examples:

- Facebook Insights
- Twitter Analytics
- LinkedIn Analytics
- Instagram Insights
- Hootsuite Analytics
- Sprout Social
- Social Blade

E. SEO analytics tools

These tools help in analyzing website performance in search engines and improving SEO strategies.

What they do:

- Track keyword rankings and positions
- Backlink analysis
- On-page SEO audit
- Organic traffic analysis
- Technical SEO issues detection
- Competitor SEO analysis

Examples:

- Google Search Console
- SEMrush
- Ahrefs
- Moz Pro
- Ubersuggest
- Screaming Frog SEO Spider

F. General enterprise analytics tools

These are advanced analytics platforms used by large organizations to collect, integrate and analyze data from multiple sources such as websites, CRM, sales, marketing, customer support, etc.

What they do:

- Enterprise-level data collection
- Cross-channel reporting
- Custom dashboards & reports
- Data integration from multiple sources
- Advanced analytics and visualization
- Predictive analytics and forecasting

Examples:

- Google Analytics 360
- Adobe Analytics
- IBM Cognos Analytics
- SAP Analytics Cloud
- Oracle Analytics Cloud
- Microsoft Power BI

G. Open source web analytics tools

These tools are free and open source. They can be self-hosted and offer flexibility and full control over data.

What they do:

- Free to use
- Full data ownership and privacy
- Highly customizable
- No vendor lock-in
- Requires technical expertise to set up

Examples:

- Matomo (formerly Piwik)
- Open Web Analytics (OWA)
- Clicky (free version with open-source option)
- Countly (open source option)
- GoAccess (real time log analyzer)

H. Product analytics tools

These tools help product teams understand how users interact with a product or feature within an app or website.

What they do:

- Track user events and actions
- Funnel analysis and retention
- Cohort analysis
- Feature usage and engagement insights
- In-app behavior analytics
- Product performance optimization

Examples:

- Mixpanel
- Amplitude
- Heap Analytics
- Pendo
- Kissmetrics
- Userpilot

★ Choosing the right web analytics tool depends on your business goals, budget, technical resources, team expertise and the type of data you want to analyze. ★

5. Setting up goals and conversion rate goal reports in Google Analytics

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Setting up Goals and Conversion Rate Goal Reports in Google Analytics

Goals in Google Analytics help you track the actions that are most important to your business. These actions are called conversions. Google Analytics allows you to set up goals and view reports that show how well your website or campaigns are achieving those goals.

1. What is a Goal?

A goal is a specific user interaction you want visitors to complete on your website.

Examples:

- Thank you page after a purchase
- Contact form submission
- Newsletter sign up
- Download a whitepaper
- Video play or other engagement actions



2. Types of Goals in Google Analytics

Google Analytics offers four types of goals:

A. Destination

Tracks a specific page (e.g., /thank-you.html) that users reach.

B. Duration

Tracks how long users stay on your site or a specific page.

C. Pages / Screens per session

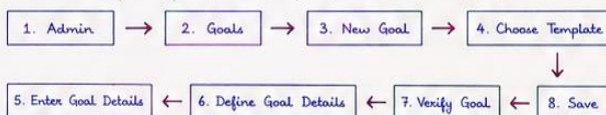
Tracks the number of pages or screens viewed in a single session.

D. Event

Tracks interactions like clicks, downloads, video plays, form submissions etc.

Note: For Destination, Duration and Pages/Screens goals, a session must be engaged. For Event goals, any event trigger counts as a conversion.

Example of Goal Setup (Destination Goal)



Example Scenario:

You run an online store. You want to track the number of users who complete a purchase.

- Goal Type : Destination
- Destination URL : /thank-you-for-your-order
- Goal Value : ₹1000 (average order value)
- Result : You can now see how many users purchased and the conversion rate.

3. Steps to Set Up Goals in Google Analytics

- Step 1: Go to Admin (⚙ icon).
- Step 2: In the View column, click Goals.
- Step 3: Click New Goal.
- Step 4: Choose a Goal Setup
 - Choose a template (recommended)
 - OR
 - Select Custom.
- Step 5: Enter Goal Details
 - Goal Name: Give your goal a clear name.
 - Goal Slot ID: Choose a slot (e.g., Goal Id 1).
 - Goal Type: Select the type of goal.
- Step 6: Define Goal Details
 - For Destination: Enter the URL of the thank-you page.
 - For Duration: Set the time duration.
 - For Pages / Screens: Enter the number of pages.
 - For Event: Set event conditions.
- Step 7: Assign a Goal Value (optional)
Assign a monetary value to conversions to measure ROI.
- Step 8: Verify the Goal
Use the Verify this Goal option to check if it works.
- Step 9: Save
Click Save to activate the goal.

Important:

It may take up to 24 hours for goal data to appear in reports.

4. Conversion Rate

Conversion Rate is the percentage of users who completed the goal out of the total users.

$$\text{Conversion Rate (\%)} = (\text{Conversions} / \text{Total Sessions}) \times 100$$

5. Goal Reports in Google Analytics

To view goal performance:

- Go to Reports → Engagement → Conversions → Goals (Universal Analytics)
- OR
- Reports → Engagement → Events → Conversions

Key Reports:

- Overview: Summary of total conversions and conversion rate.
- Goal URLs / Goal paths: See which pages lead to conversions.
- Reverse Goal Path: See the steps users took before converting.
- Goal Flow: Visualize the path users take to complete the goal.

Why Goals and Conversion Reports are Important?

- ✓ Measure the success of your marketing campaigns.
- ✓ Identify high performing pages and traffic sources.
- ✓ Calculate ROI and revenue generated.
- ✓ Make data-driven decisions to improve conversions.

